Alex Kinsella

Head of Strategic Procurement | Mechanical & Plant Engineering

Heidelberg, Germany · [Telephone] · [Email] · Irish (EU citizen) · Available immediately

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Procurement professional with about 21 years of purchasing experience in the German mechanical and plant engineering sector, most recently eight years as Head of Strategic Procurement at a mid-sized industrial pump manufacturer (team of six strategic buyers, approx. EUR 85m annual direct material spend). Experience covers category strategy, supplier selection and development in Germany and Central Europe, contract negotiation, supply risk management through the 2021–2022 shortages, the procurement workstream of an SAP S/4HANA migration and implementation of the German Supply Chain Act (LkSG). Native English speaker; living and working in Germany since 1999.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Rheinmark Industrietechnik GmbH, Mannheim

Industrial centrifugal pumps for water utilities and process industries (approx. 1,400 employees; part of the Nordvik Group since 2024)

Head of Strategic Procurement — Apr 2018 – Jun 2026

- Led a team of six strategic buyers; responsible for approx. EUR 85m annual direct material spend; reported to the managing director.
- Developed and implemented category strategies; owned supplier risk management, procurement KPIs and reporting.
- Procurement lead in the SAP S/4HANA migration (2019–2020).
- Built LkSG supplier risk analysis and due diligence processes from 2023, ahead of the Act applying to the company in 2024.
- Coordinated with group procurement during integration after the 2024 acquisition by the Nordvik Group.
- Kept production supplied through 2021–2022 by qualifying alternative motor and electronics suppliers and introducing safety-stock agreements for critical items.
- Reduced the casting supplier base from 14 to 8 while increasing the share of spend under framework agreements.
- Achieved average annual material cost reductions of approximately 2–3% on negotiated categories in the non-crisis years (2018–2019, 2023–2025).
- Established the company’s first documented LkSG risk analysis, covering approx. 600 direct suppliers.

Senior Strategic Buyer — Apr 2016 – Mar 2018

- Commodity responsibility for castings, motors and seals.
- Supplier negotiations and framework agreements; supplier audits together with Quality.

Position ended 30 June 2026 by mutual agreement following the centralisation of procurement at group level.

Strategic Buyer — Jul 2009 – Mar 2016

Neckartal Hydraulik GmbH, Heilbronn – hydraulic cylinders and power units

- Commodity responsibility for forgings, castings and machined steel parts (approx. EUR 30–38m annual spend).
- Supplier selection and development with suppliers in Germany, the Czech Republic and Poland; framework contract negotiation.
- Participated in new product introduction projects with Engineering.
- Established dual sourcing for high-volume cylinder tubes after a single-source supply disruption in 2011.
- Led supplier development for two Czech forging suppliers, including on-site audits and quality improvement plans.

Buyer — Sep 2005 – Jun 2009

Brandt & Söhne Fördertechnik GmbH, Wiesloch – conveyor and material-handling systems

- Operational and tactical purchasing of machined parts, sheet-metal parts and standard components in SAP R/3.
- RFQs, price comparisons, order processing, delivery follow-up; annual supplier evaluations.

- Introduced a structured supplier evaluation scorecard for the machined-parts supplier base, building on my Diplom thesis.

Commercial Assistant, Export Sales Administration Sep 1999 – Aug 2001

Kessler Antriebstechnik GmbH, Mannheim – gear drives

- Order processing and correspondence for English-speaking export customers (UK, Ireland, North America); shipping and export documentation.
- Supported the purchasing department with correspondence and price requests to English-speaking suppliers.

EDUCATION

Oct 2001 – Jul 2005	**Diplom-Wirtschaftsingenieur (FH)** – Industrial Engineering and Management, focus on procurement and logistics Hochschule Kurpfalz für Technik und Wirtschaft, Mannheim · Final grade 2.1 (“gut”) Thesis on supplier evaluation systems for machined components, in cooperation with Brandt & Söhne Fördertechnik
Sep 1997 – Jun 1999	**National Certificate in Business Studies** (two-year full-time programme), Pass with Merit Suir Valley Institute of Technology, Waterford, Ireland

PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

2023	Supply Chain Due Diligence Act (LkSG) in practice – one-day seminar
2019	SAP S/4HANA key user training, procurement (MM)
2018 – 2019	Leadership development programme (4 modules), Rheinmark Industrietechnik
2012	Negotiation techniques in purchasing – two-day seminar

SKILLS

- Strategic procurement and category management for direct materials: castings, forgings, machined parts, motors, seals, hydraulic components
- Supplier selection, qualification, audits and development, including Central European suppliers
- Contract and price negotiation; framework agreements
- Supply risk management, dual sourcing, shortage management
- Team leadership, procurement KPIs and management reporting
- SAP MM (R/3 and S/4HANA); MS Excel for spend analysis; MS Office
- LkSG implementation and supplier risk analysis

LANGUAGES

English – Native · German – C1